Ohio Is a Close Race Again This Election

From: PBS NewsHour Mined: 2026-10-20 3 min read

For many years, Ohio has voted for Republicans in big presidential elections. But this year, the state is a **battleground** again. That means either party could win.

A group that studies elections, The Cook Political Report, says the races for Ohio **governor** and for a U.S. Senate seat are **toss-ups**. That means they are too close to call. Election Day is about two weeks away.

Many voters are worried about **affordability**, or paying for everyday things. In the city of Youngstown, many factory jobs left long ago. This summer, a bakery closed after 120 years.

In the Senate race, Democrat Sherrod Brown wants to win back a seat he lost two years ago. He says Republicans made life more expensive. His **opponent**, Jon Husted, says in an ad that 32 years in Washington is enough for Brown.

Gas prices went up because of the war with Iran. Husted said the war needs to end so prices can come down.

Word Treasure

battleground -- A place where an election is close and both sides try hard to win.
governor -- The leader of a U.S. state's government.
toss-ups -- Races so close that no one can tell who will win.
affordability -- Whether people have enough money to pay for things.
opponent -- The person you are competing against.

Background you need

In an election, people vote to choose leaders, such as governors and senators.

Senators work in Washington and help make laws for the whole country.

When prices go up, many voters think about which leaders could help their families.

Break it down

WHO: Ohio voters and Senate candidates Sherrod Brown and Jon Husted
WHAT: The races for governor and U.S. Senate are too close to call
WHERE: Ohio, including the city of Youngstown
WHY: Many voters are worried about paying for everyday things like gas

Why it matters

The leaders voters choose can make decisions about prices and jobs that affect families like yours.

Test what you remember

1. What does it mean that Ohio is a battleground?

- (A) Nobody can vote there
- (B) It has a big army
- (C) Either party could win
- (D) It always picks Democrats

2. What does a toss-up race mean?

- (A) Only one person is running
- (B) It is a sports game
- (C) It is too close to call
- (D) It is already over

3. What closed in Youngstown this summer?

- (A) A zoo
- (B) A bakery that was 120 years old
- (C) A school
- (D) A park

4. Who is the Democrat in the Senate race?

- (A) Jon Husted
- (B) Liz Landers
- (C) Chris Anderson
- (D) Sherrod Brown

5. Why did gas prices go up?

- (A) Because of a holiday
- (B) Because of snow
- (C) Because of the war with Iran
- (D) Because cars got bigger

6. About how far away is Election Day?

- (A) Two years
- (B) Two months
- (C) Tomorrow
- (D) About two weeks

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: B 4: D 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Sherrod Brown: Says Republicans made life more expensive.

2. Jon Husted: Says 32 years in Washington is enough for Brown, and that the war needs to end so prices can come down.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):